FIGHTERBASE

Vegetarian

Diet guide

No meat or fish. Eggs and dairy included.



Prepared 10 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Vegetarian**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Vegetarian?

No meat, poultry or seafood. Eggs and dairy stay in, which makes hitting protein much easier than fully plant-based.

Where it comes from

People have avoided meat for religious, ethical and health reasons for thousands of years. The word 'vegetarian' became common in the 1840s with the founding of the Vegetarian Society in England.

The main ideas

1. No meat, poultry, fish or shellfish, and nothing made from slaughter (gelatine, animal rennet in some cheeses, meat stock, lard).
2. Eggs and dairy are included.
3. Beans, lentils, tofu, eggs and dairy provide protein.
4. Vegetables, fruit, wholegrains, nuts and seeds fill out the plate.

Who it suits

- People avoiding meat for ethical, religious, environmental or health reasons

Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:

- You are pregnant or breastfeeding
- You are a child or teenager
- You have signs of low iron such as constant tiredness

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Eggs, dairy, beans, lentils, tofu and tempeh deliver protein for recovery.
- Combine rice or bread with beans or lentils to broaden amino acids across the day.
- Rice, pasta, potatoes, oats and fruit around training.
- Pair iron foods with vitamin C.

> Eggs, Greek yoghurt or a dairy shake after training. Lentils, beans and grains for fuel.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Iron
plant iron absorbs less well
Where: lentils, beans, dark greens, fortified cereal, wholegrains

Vitamin B12
eggs and dairy help
Where: eggs, dairy, fortified foods

Zinc
wholegrains and legumes contain phytates
Where: pumpkin seeds, beans, nuts, dairy, wholegrains

Omega-3
no fish
Where: walnuts, flax, chia, algae-based supplement

Creatine
vegetarians have lower stores
Where: creatine monohydrate supplement can help; ask a professional

Common mistakes

- Relying on cheese and pasta
- Not planning protein
- Ignoring iron and B12
- Too many processed meat alternatives

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Gelatine (E441), animal rennet, lard, suet
- Parmesan and some cheeses use animal rennet: look for 'suitable for vegetarians'
- Worcestershire sauce contains anchovies
- Some sweets and yoghurts use gelatine or carmine (E120)

Eating out

- Look for the V symbol or ask.
- Check soups, risottos and sauces for meat or fish stock.
- Choose bean, lentil, egg, cheese or tofu dishes.

Easy swaps

Beef mince	→	Lentils, soya mince or mushrooms
Chicken	→	Tofu, eggs or halloumi
Gelatine sweets	→	Pectin-based sweets
Parmesan	→	Vegetarian hard cheese

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Porridge, banana, nuts	Hummus and salad wrap	Lentil bolognese with pasta
Tue	Eggs on toast	Cheese and bean jacket potato	Chickpea and spinach curry with rice
Wed	Greek yoghurt, berries, granola	Vegetable soup and bread	Tofu stir-fry with noodles
Thu	Peanut butter toast, fruit	Egg fried rice with veg	Bean chilli with rice
Fri	Omelette and toast	Falafel and tabbouleh bowl	Paneer and vegetable curry
Sat	Pancakes with fruit	Halloumi and roasted vegetable wrap	Veggie burgers, wedges, salad
Sun	Scrambled egg on toast	Leftovers bowl	Roasted vegetable and lentil bake

Snacks

Hummus and veg · Fruit and nuts · Yoghurt · Boiled eggs · Roasted chickpeas

Shopping list

Eggs, milk, yoghurt, cheese · Tofu, tempeh, soya mince · Beans, lentils, chickpeas · Oats, rice, pasta, wholemeal bread · Vegetables and fruit · Nuts, seeds, nut butter

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Can I build muscle as a vegetarian?

Yes. Eggs, dairy, soy and legumes provide plenty of protein if you eat enough overall and train.

Do I need supplements?

Not always. B12, vitamin D and iron are the ones to watch. A blood test through a GP can help.

Further reading

The Vegetarian Society; British Dietetic Association; NHS vegetarian guidance.

For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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